



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

avatīrya ca pasparśa | nistīrṇam iti vājinam |
chandakaṃ* ca*abravīt prītaḥ | snāpayann* iva cakṣuṣā || 6.4 |
imaṃ* tārṣya+upama+javaṃ* | turaṃ+gam anugacchatā |
darśitā saumya mad+bhaktir* | vikramaś* ca*ayam ātmanaḥ || 6.5 |

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 6, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Having dismounted, Siddhartha gently touched his horse, Kanthaka, whispering words of accomplishment, "You have carried me across." He spoke with affection to Chandaka, his loyal charioteer, his gaze almost like a soothing bath. These verses paint a beautiful picture of gratitude and recognition at a pivotal moment in Siddhartha's journey of renunciation. He acknowledges Kanthaka's incredible speed, comparing it to that of Garuda, the mythical bird known for its swiftness. To Chandaka, he expresses appreciation for his devotion and courage in following him on this arduous path. Siddhartha sees Chandaka's actions as a demonstration of his unwavering faith and personal strength.

The spiritual significance here extends beyond simple thankfulness. It reveals the importance of acknowledging the contributions of everything and everyone that aids us on our spiritual journey. Kanthaka represents the tools, resources, and even the inherent talents we possess. Chandaka embodies the support system we cultivate – the friends, mentors, and loved ones who encourage us along the way. Siddhartha's gratitude isn't just polite; it's an understanding that his progress is intertwined with the efforts of others and the gifts he has been given.

In your own life, consider the "Kanthakas" and "Chandakas" that enable your growth. Are you truly acknowledging the resources available to you, the blessings you've been given, and the people who support your aspirations? Often, we focus solely on our own efforts, forgetting the interconnectedness of our journey. Practicing gratitude, as Siddhartha demonstrated, cultivates humility and strengthens our relationships. Recognizing the contributions of others and the gifts we possess allows us to move forward with greater awareness and appreciation. It transforms our striving into a collaborative dance, enriching both our personal journey and the lives of those around us.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you intentionally express gratitude to the "Kanthakas" and "Chandakas" in your life today, recognizing their role in your personal and spiritual growth?